

- Pre-main-sequence evolution, 425–441
- Precession, 12
- Pressure
 - defined, 286
- Pressure broadening, 270–271
- Pressure equation of state, 288–296
- Pressure integral
 - defined, 290
- Pressure scale height, 316–317
- Pressure-supported galaxies, 989
- Pressureless “dust” model of universe, 1146–1156
- Primary star, 658, 659
- Prime focus, 156
- Primordial black holes, 639, 645
- Principal focus, 26
- Principal quantum number, 124, 133
- Principle of equivalence, 613–616, 619
- Principle of relativity, 88, 89, 102
- Probability, 129
- Procyon, 112
- Prolate spheroidal galaxies, 943, 944
- Prometheus, 792, 805
- Prompt initial enhancement, 1020
- Proper distance, 626, 1189, 1211
- Proper length, 95, 626
- Proper motion, 17, 112
- Proper time, 93, 625
- Proplyds, 440
- Proto-Galactic cloud, 1017, 1023
- Proton–proton chain (PP I), 309–311, 352
 - PP I reaction chain, 309
 - PP II reaction chain, 310
 - PP III reaction chain, 310
- Protons
 - Big Bang nucleosynthesis, 1177–1178
 - isotopes, 298
 - mass of, 299
- Protostars, 412–424
 - ambipolar diffusion, 421
 - birth line, 429
 - homologous collapse, 414–417
 - inside-out collapse, 417
 - Jeans criterion, 412–413, 419
 - numerical simulations, 422
- Proxima Centauri, 59
- PSR 0031–07, 598
- PSR 0329+54, 595
- PSR 0531–21, 599
- PSR 0633+1746, 590
- PSR 1237+25, 598
- PSR 1257+12, 703
- PSR 1641–45, 596
- PSR 1744–24A, 703
- PSR 1913+16, 700, 703, 704
- PSR 1919+21, 587, 588
- PSR 1937+214, 701
- PSR 1957+20, 702
- Ptolemaic model, 4, 7
- Pulsars, 538, 586–602, 1114
 - as rapidly rotating neutron stars, 590
 - characteristics, 588–589
 - emission mechanism, 600
 - glitches, 590, 602
 - millisecond, 590
 - models, 589–590, 596–599
 - origin, 592
 - period derivatives, 599, 601
 - structure of pulses, 595
 - wind, 601
- Pulsating variable stars, 63, 68, 251, 589
 - see also* Stellar pulsation
- Pulse period, 587
- Pythagoras, 2
- Q0142–100, 1131
- Q0957+561, 1130, 1133, 1136
- Q2237+031, 1135
- QSOs, *see* Quasi-stellar objects
- QSRs, *see* Quasi-stellar radio sources
- Quantization
 - of energy, 71–75
- Quantum, 73
- Quantum mechanical tunneling, 131, 132, 300–302
- Quantum mechanics, 116, 132
- Quantum numbers, 124, 133, 135, 136
- Quantum state, 135
- Quaoar, 717
- Quark era, 1231
- Quark–hadron transition, 1231, 1246
- Quarks, 1230, 1231, 1246
- Quasars, 1095–1104, 1107
 - discovery of, 1096
 - evolution of, 1100–1104
 - high cosmological redshifts, 1099
 - luminosity of, 1097
 - Lyman- α forest, 1137–1139
 - polarization, 1104
 - spectra of, 1095, 1097–1098, 1137–1139
- Quasi-stellar objects (QSOs), 1099, 1107
- Quasi-stellar radio sources (QSRs), 1096, 1107
- Queloz, Didier, 195, 848
- Quiescent prominences, 388, 389
- Quiet corona, 390
- Quintessence, 1192
- $r^{1/4}$ law, 892
- r -process nucleosynthesis, 542
- Rabinowitz, David, 826
- Radial velocity, 16, 98
 - binary stars, 186–187
 - to detect extrasolar planets, 195, 196
- Radians (unit), 58
- Radiant, 842
- Radiant flux, 60
- Radiation, 315
- Radiation constant, 234
- Radiation era, 1174
- Radiation field, 231–237
 - intensity, 231–232, 235
 - radiation pressure, 236–237
 - radiative flux, 234–235
 - specific energy density, 233–234
- Radiation pressure, 67, 236–237, 295
- Radiation pressure gradient, 255

- Radiation torus, 1113
- Radiative flux, 234–235
- Radiative temperature gradient, 316, 325
- Radiative transfer, 251–266
 - Eddington approximation, 262–263
 - limb darkening, 254, 264–266
 - radiation pressure gradient, 255
 - random walk, 252–254
 - transfer equation, 255–266
- Radio astronomy, 161
- Radio galaxies, 1093, 1107
 - core, 1092
 - halo, 1092
 - radio lobes and jets, 1092
- Radio interferometry, 164–165
- Radio lobes, 1090–1092, 1122
 - formation of, 1123
- Radio map, 161, 162
- Radio telescopes, 161–167
- Radio waves, 66
- Radioactive dating, 756–759
- Radioactive decay
 - supernovae, 534
- Radius of curvature (lens), 143
- Radius–luminosity relation, 956
- Ram-pressure stripping, 985
- Random walk, 252–254
- Rapidly oscillating roAp stars, *see* roAp stars
- Rayet, G., 521
- Rayleigh criterion, 147
- Rayleigh scattering, 247, 402
- Rayleigh, Lord, 71
- Rayleigh–Jeans law, 72, 73
- Reaction rates
 - electron screening and, 306
 - Gamow peak, 305
 - nuclear reactions, 302–307
 - resonance and, 306
- Recessional velocity, 1054
- Recombination, 1181–1182, 1253
- Red edge, 498
- Red giant branch (stellar evolution), 460
- Red giant tip, 461
- Red supergiant stars (RSG), 522
- Reddening
 - interstellar reddening, 401
- Redshift, 98
 - cosmological redshift, 1099, 1199–1201
- Redshift parameter, 99
- Redshift surveys, 1073–1076
- Redshift–magnitude relation, 1212–1215, 1217
- Reduced mass, 42, 122, 125
- Reflecting telescopes, 141, 155–158
- Reflection, 143
- Reflection grating, 113
- Reflection nebula, 402
- Reflex motion, 196, 197
- Reflex radial velocity, 848
- Refracting telescopes, 141, 154–155
- Refractories, 756
- Refractory inclusions, 839
- Regolith, 739
- Reionization, 1256
- Relativistic beaming, 1128
- Relativistic cosmology, 1183–1199
- Relativistic Doppler shift, 98
- Relativistic jets, 548, 549, 699
- Relativistic kinetic energy, 102–104
- Relativistic momentum, 102, 105–106
- Relativistic velocity
 - transformation, 100
- Relativity, 88, 89
 - see also* Special relativity *see also* General theory of relativity; Spacetime
- Resolution, 147
- Resolving power, 113
- Resonance, 306
- Resonance effects
 - in early Solar System, 868
- Rest energy, 103
- Rest frame, 93
- Rest length, 626
- Rest mass energy, 299
- Retrograde motion, 3, 6–7
- Retrograde rotation, 741–742, 816, 861
- Reverberation mapping, 1117
- RGB, *see* Red giant branch
- Riemann, Bernhard, 1185
- Rigel, 68, 69, 112
- Right ascension, 12
- Riley, J. M., 1105
- Ring galaxies, 1005–1008
- Ring systems, *see* Planetary ring systems
 - of Jupiter, 802, 804
 - of Neptune, 805
 - of Saturn, 775, 801–804, 806
 - of Uranus, 802, 804, 807
- Ritchey–Chrétien telescope, 158, 160
- roAp stars, 512
- Robertson, Howard Percy, 1189
- Robertson–Walker metric, 1189, 1201
- Roche limit, 723–724
- Roche lobes, 658, 659, 670
- Roche, Edouard, 658, 723
- Roemer, Ole, 63
- Roentgen Satellite (ROSAT), 170
- ROSAT (Roentgen Satellite), 170
- Rosetta spacecraft, 824
- Rosseland mean opacity, 249–250, 260
- Rosseland, Svein, 249
- Rotation
 - of stars, 380
 - of Sun, 380
- Rotation curves, 915–917, 951–952
- Rotationally supported galaxies, 989
- Rovibrational bands, 407
- RR Centauri, 194
- RR Lyrae, 470
- RR Lyrae stars, 490, 491, 877, 895, 921, 1040
 - P*–*V* diagram, 494, 495
 - partial ionization zone, 496
- RS Canum Venaticorum stars, 672
- RSG, *see* Red supergiant stars
- Rubin, Vera, 915

- Runge–Kutta algorithm, [A-25](#)
 Russell, Henry Norris, [221](#)
 Rutherford, Ernest, [119](#)
 Rydberg constant, [120](#), [125](#)
 Rydberg, Johannes, [120](#)
 Ryle, Martin, [587](#)

 S Doradus variables, [519](#)
 S waves, [749](#), [750](#)
 s-process nucleosynthesis, [467](#),
 [542](#)
 S-star binaries, [673](#)
 S2, [923](#), [924](#)
 Sachs–Wolfe effect, [1260](#)
 Sagan, Carl, [763](#)
 SAGE, [358](#), [359](#)
 Sagittarius
 radio sources in, [926–929](#)
 Sagittarius A (Sgr A), [927](#)
 Saha equation, [213–215](#), [1181](#)
 Saha, Meghnad, [214](#)
 Sakigake spacecraft, [821](#)
 Salam, Abdus, [1236](#)
 Salpeter, Edwin E., [1019](#)
 SALT (Southern African Large
 Telescope), [159](#)
 Sandage, Allan, [519](#), [1016](#), [1041](#),
 [1095](#)
 Sanduleak, Nicholas, [524](#), [699](#)
 SAS-1 (Small Astronomy
 Satellite-1), [170](#)
 Satellite
 orbit, [631–633](#)
 Satellites, *see* Moons
 Saturn, [715](#), [719](#)
 atmosphere of, [778](#), [785](#)
 composition of, [859](#)
 cooling timescale, [785](#)
 core of, [783](#)
 energy budgets and effective
 temperatures, [784](#)
 gravitational moments, [781](#)
 interior structure of, [785](#), [786](#)
 mass-radius relationship, [778](#)
 moment of inertia, [781](#)
 moons of, [715–716](#), [723](#), [776](#),
 [797–799](#)
 orbit, [6](#)
 ring system, [724](#), [775](#),
 [801–804](#), [806](#)
 spacecraft missions to, [777](#)
 Scalar Higgs boson, [1230](#), [1231](#)
 Scale factor, [1148](#)
 Scaliger, Joseph Justus, [14](#)
 Schödel, Rainer, [923](#)
 Schechter, Paul, [991](#)
 Schiaparelli, Giovanni Virginio,
 [762](#)
 Schmidt telescope, [158](#)
 Schmidt, Brian, [1214](#)
 Schmidt, Maarten, [1096](#)
 Schönberg–Chandrasekhar limit,
 [451](#), [458](#), [478](#)
 derivation, [453–456](#)
 Schrödinger’s equation, [132–133](#)
 Schrödinger, Erwin, [132](#)
 Schroeder, M. C., [A-26](#)
 Schuster–Schwarzschild model,
 [272](#), [273](#)
 Schwarzschild metric, [630](#), [634](#),
 [635](#), [638](#), [639](#), [1185](#), [1189](#)
 Schwarzschild radius, [1111](#)
 Schwarzschild throat, [642](#)
 Schwarzschild, Karl, [630](#)
 Sco X-1, [691](#)
 SCP, *see* Supernova Cosmology
 Project
 Sculptor group, [1061](#)
 SDSS, *see* Sloan Digital Sky
 Survey
 SDSS 023137.65–072854.4,
 [1099](#)
 SDSS 1030+0524, [99](#), [100](#),
 [1056](#), [1159](#)
 SDSS 17100.62+641209.0,
 [1099](#)
 Second dredge-up phase, [463](#)
 Second overtone, [493](#)
 Secondary star, [658](#), [659](#)
 Sector boundary, [820](#)
 Secular parallax, [922](#), [1039](#)
 SED, *see* Spectral energy
 distribution
 Sedna, [717](#)
 Seeing, [148](#)
 Seismic waves
 on Earth, [749](#), [750](#)
 Selection rules, [136](#)

 Sellgren, Kristen, [923](#)
 Semidetached binary, [658](#), [659](#)
 accretion disks, [661](#), [662](#)
 eclipsing systems, [667](#)
 mass transfer rate, [658–661](#)
 white dwarfs in, [673–686](#)
 Semimajor axis, [25](#)
 Semiminor axis, [26](#)
 Sensitivity function, [76](#), [78](#)
 Sérsic profile, [951](#)
 Seyfert galaxies, [1085–1087](#),
 [1107](#), [1108](#), [1116](#), [1117](#),
 [1129](#)
 Seyfert 1 galaxies, [1085](#),
 [1086](#), [1107](#), [1108](#), [1117](#)
 Seyfert 2 galaxies, [1085](#), [1086](#),
 [1107](#), [1108](#), [1117](#), [1120](#)
 Seyfert, Carl K., [1085](#)
 SFR, *see* Star formation rate
 SGB, *see* Subgiant branch
 Sgr A, [927](#), [929](#)
 Sgr A East, [928](#)
 Sgr A West, [928](#)
 Sgr A*, [928](#), [932](#)
 supermassive black hole in,
 [929–931](#)
 SGRs, *see* Soft gamma repeaters
 Shadow zones, [749](#)
 Shapley concentration, [1071](#)
 Shapley, Harlow, [487](#), [877](#), [882](#),
 [894](#), [941](#), [1039](#), [1040](#)
 Shapley–Curtis Debate, [941–942](#)
 Shelton, Ian, [524](#)
 Shepherd moons, [805](#)
 Shklovsky, I., [592](#)
 Shock front, [377](#)
 Shock wave, [377](#)
 Shoemaker, Eugene M., [834](#)
 Short–hard gamma ray bursts,
 [547](#), [705](#)
 Short-period comets, [825](#)
 Shu, Frank, [869](#)
 Sidereal period, [6](#)
 Sidereal time, [10](#)
 Silk damping, [1252](#)
 Silk, Joseph, [1252](#)
 SIM PlanetQuest mission, [59](#),
 [172](#), [856](#), [922](#)
 Simon, George, [509](#)

- Simultaneity, 92
- Sines, law of, 17
- Single-line spectroscopic binary
 - star system, 188
- Single-slit diffraction, 145–146
- Sirius, 76, 112, 224
- Sirius A, 557, 558
- Sirius B
 - discovery, 557–559
 - electron degeneracy, 566, 569
 - gravitational redshift and, 622
- SIRTF (Spitzer Space Telescope), 168
- Skyview, 172
- SL9, *see* Comet P/Shoemaker–Levy 9
- Slattery, Wayne, 740
- Slipher, Vesto M., 941, 1052
- Sloan Digital Sky Survey (SDSS), 172, 204, 1078, 1099
- Slow novae, 681
- Small Astronomy Satellite–1 (SAS-1), 170
- Small Magellanic Cloud (SMC), 467, 484, 891, 945, 948, 1059
 - Cepheids in, 486
- SMBHs, *see* Supermassive black holes
- SMC, *see* Small Magellanic Cloud
- SMC X-1, 696
- SN 1006, 524, 553
- SN 1963p, 1043
- SN 1987A, 524, 525, 536–541
- SN 1993J, 528
- SN 1997ff, 1214
- SN 1998bw, 547
- SN 2003dh, 547
- SNAP spacecraft, *see* Supernova/Acceleration Probe
- Snell's law, 141, 142
- Snow line, 860, 865
- SNR, *see* Supernova remnants
- SNU, *see* Solar neutrino unit
- Snyder, Hartland, 634
- Sodium
 - spectral lines, 275–276
- Soft gamma repeaters (SGRs), 603
- Softening factor, A-27
- SOHO (Solar and Heliospheric Observatory), 172, 825
- Solar antapex, 906
- Solar apex, 906
- Solar atmosphere, 360–380
 - chromosphere, 364–365
 - corona, 366–370, 390
 - coronal holes, 370–372
 - granulation, 363–365
 - hydrodynamic equations, 376
 - magnetohydrodynamics, 377–380
 - Parker spiral, 380
 - photosphere, 274, 277–278, 360–362, 379
 - plages, 385
 - solar flares, 386–388
 - solar prominences, 388, 389
 - solar wind, 370–374
 - spicules, 365
 - sunspots, 381–385
 - supergranulation, 365
 - transition region, 365–366
- Solar circle, 883
- Solar constant, 61
- Solar convection zone, 511
- Solar cosmic rays, 386
- Solar cycle, 381–393
 - coronal mass ejections, 389, 390
 - magnetic dynamo theory, 391–392
 - plages, 385
 - solar flares, 386–388
 - solar prominences, 388, 389
 - sunspots, 381–385
- Solar eclipse
 - bending of starlight, 613
- Solar flares, 386–388
- Solar galactocentric distance, 882, 883
- Solar granulation, 363–364
 - supergranulation, 365
- Solar irradiance, 61
- Solar lithium problem, 542
- Solar model, 350
- Solar motion, 904
- Solar nebula
 - temperature gradient in, 859
- Solar neutrino problem, 356–360, 540
- Solar neutrino unit (SNU), 357
- Solar oscillations, 509, 512
- Solar prominences, 388, 389
- Solar spectrum, 112, 114, 238
- Solar System
 - see also* Asteroids; Comets; Moons; Planets
 - age of, 350
 - angular momentum
 - distribution, 858–859
 - collisions and bombardment, 860
 - composition trends in, 859
 - evolution, 840
 - formation, 718–719
 - formation of, 857, 861–869
 - minor bodies in, 832
 - planetary atmosphere, 724–730
 - resonance effects in, 868
 - survey of, 714–719
 - synchronous rotation, 722–723
 - tidal forces, 719–724
 - water in, 829
- Solar time, 9
- Solar wind, 370–374
 - Parker wind model, 375–376
- Solid angle, 151
- Solstice, 10, 11
- Sonic horizon distance, 1262
- Sound
 - Doppler shift, 97
- Sound speed, 377
 - adiabatic, 321
 - isothermal, 414
- Source function, 257, 258
- Southern African Large Telescope (SALT), 159
- Southern lights, 373
- Southern Wall, 1076
- Space Interferometry Mission, 59
- Space-based observatories, 160,

- 171
- Spacelike interval, 109
- Spacetime, 92
 - curvature of, 609–613, 618, 622, 628, 1185–1190
 - diagrams, 623
 - frame dragging, 640
 - intervals, 624, 625
 - metric for flat spacetimes, 626–628
 - Schwarzschild metric, 630, 634, 635, 638, 639
 - worldlines, 623–624
- Spacetime interval, 109
- Spallation reactions, 388
- Special relativity, 88, 102
 - see also* General theory of relativity
 - space in, 94–95
 - time in, 92–94
- Specific energy density, 233–234
- Specific heat, 318–320
- Specific intensity, 231, 235
- Specific radiative flux, 234–235
- Specific volume, 319
- Spectral classification, *see* Spectral types
- Spectral energy distribution (SED), 1088
- Spectral flux density, 161–162
- Spectral index, 1088
- Spectral lines, 111–116, 220
 - see also* Stellar spectra
 - active galactic nuclei, 1087, 1116–1120
 - broadening, 268–271
 - calcium, 218
 - collisional broadening, 270
 - curve of growth, 273–276
 - Doppler broadening, 269–270
 - equivalent widths, 267
 - hydrogen, 120, 121, 124–127, 203, 213, 216, 218, 226
 - natural broadening, 268
 - optically thin, 267
 - pressure broadening, 270–271
 - quasars, 1095, 1097–1098, 1137–1139
 - Seyfert galaxies, 1108
 - solar, 362, 365
 - Sun, 112, 114
 - T Tauri stars, 434
 - Voigt profile, 271–273
 - Zeeman effect, 134
- Spectral types, 202, 204, 205
 - A, 204, 205
 - B, 204, 205
 - C, 205, 466, 467
 - F, 205
 - G, 205
 - Harvard spectral classification, 204, 205
 - K, 204, 205, 466
 - L, 204, 205
 - M, 205, 466, 467
 - O, 204, 205
 - S, 205, 467
 - T, 204, 205
- Spectrographs, 113
- Spectroscopic binary star system, 182, 186–193
- Spectroscopic parallax, 225, 475, 1039
- Spectroscopy, 111
- Spectrum binary star system, 181–182
- Speed of light, 63, 87
 - constancy, 88, 90
- Spherical aberration, 150
- Spherical harmonics
 - stellar pulsation, 503, 504
- Spherical trigonometry, 17–19
- Spheroidal mirror, 143
- Spicules, 365
- Spin angular momentum, 135
- Spiral density waves, 806
- Spiral galaxies, 942, 944, 946, 948–958
 - characteristics of, 949
 - color gradient, 957–958
 - color of, 956
 - gas and dust in, 957
 - luminosity class, 947
 - luminosity function, 991
 - mass and mass-to-light ratio, 956
 - merger of, 1029
 - metallicity gradients, 958
- N*-body simulations, 981–983
- radius–luminosity relation, 956
- rotation curves, 915, 917, 951
- structure of, 964–983
- X-ray luminosity, 958
- Spiral structure, 964–983
 - closed orbits in noninertial frames, 977–979
 - density wave theory, 967–968
 - small-amplitude orbital perturbations, 969–976
 - stochastic, self-propagating star formation (SSPSF), 983
 - trailing and leading spiral arms, 966, 968
 - winding problem, 966–967
- Spitzer Infrared Telescope, 169
- Spitzer Space Telescope (SIRTF), 168
- Spitzer, Lyman, Jr., 168
- Spring tides, 723
- Sputtering, 795
- Squire, J. C., 71
- SS 433, 699–701
- SS Cygni, 679
- Stability coefficient, 503
- Star counts
 - differential star counts, 880–881
 - integrated star counts, 879
 - Kapteyn's method, 876, 878
 - modern methods, 881
 - Olbers's paradox, 881
- Star formation
 - stochastic, self-propagating, 983
- Star formation rate (SFR), 1018, 1020
- Starburst galaxies, 1011, 1013
- Stardust spacecraft, 823
- Stars
 - see also* specific types of stars; headings under Stellar atmosphere, *see* Stellar atmosphere
 - constellations, A-3–A-4
 - energy sources, 296–315